

The Noble Great Strength: A Sūtra of the Great Vehicle

Ārya-Mahābala-nāma-mahāyānasūtra · Toh 757 · Derge Kangyur

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Toh 757 in the Kangyur is a Mahāyāna sūtra known in English as "The Noble Great Strength," in Sanskrit as the Ārya-Mahābala-nāma-mahāyānasūtra, and in Tibetan as Phags pa stobs po che zhes bya ba theg pa chen po'i mdo. It belongs to the general class of sūtra literature and centers on the bodhisattva Great Strength, a powerful four-armed figure associated with Vajrapāṇi, presenting teachings delivered by the Buddha on Gṛdhrakūṭa mountain in the presence of this great being. The text combines narrative and ritual elements, including mantras, and sits within the broader Kangyur collection of translated scriptures regarded as buddhavacana, or the word of the Buddha.

The praise with mantra to Smoky Flame (Skt. Umertseg), King of Wrathful Ones, is complete.

In the language of India: Ārya-Mahābala-nāma-mahāyāna-sūtra. In the Tibetan language: The Noble Great Strength, a sūtra of the Great Vehicle.

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time, the Blessed One was teaching the Dharma on the great Gṛdhrakūṭa mountain. Then the bodhisattva, the great being Vajrapāṇi — praised, lauded, honored, and delighted by all buddhas — was also present there.

Then, with his hand, the Blessed One gave ease to sentient beings, and took his seat upon a lotus throne wreathed in a garland of flames blazing on all sides, in the eastern direction.

To the right of the Blessed One stood Great Strength with four arms: in one hand holding a fan, with another hand paying homage, in the right holding a sword, and in the left holding a lasso, with hair blazing upward and eyes red. Below him were the Blessed One Vajrapāṇi together with his retinue. To the right was Śuddhaviṣa, king of vidyā-mantras. To the left was Amṛtakundalī. The heart-essences were then placed in the likeness of a moon-disk. The heart-essences are Kilikilī, the dhāraṇī of soaring flight, Red Body, Vajravidaraṇa, and Vajramahābharaṇa — these are the supreme

heart-essences. Near the great fierce king of vidyā-mantras was the noble Māmakī. Below the noble Amṛtakundaī were the vajra-hook and the vajra chain. On the inner side of the doorway, the wrathful ones with vajra-hammer and vajra-sword were placed facing outward. On the left side were the Blessed One Avalokiteśvara together with his retinue. To the right of the Blessed One was White Garment. Below her were Tārā and the Frowning One. To the left were Hayagrīva, king of vidyā-mantras, and along with him a hundred thousand great bodhisattvas, great beings.

Likewise, in the eastern direction were the Moon, the Sun, Virūḍhaka, and Śakra (Indra, king of gods). In the direction of fire were the great fire sages and their retinues. In the southern direction were Yama and Viṣṇu. In the direction of the rākṣasas were the lord of demonesses, the mother spirits and their retinues. In the western direction were the lord of nāgas and the nāgas and others with their retinues. In the direction of wind was the wind deity together with his retinue. In the northern direction was Kubera together with his retinue. In the direction of the lord of lords was the host of lords of lords. Śakra, lord of gods, Viṣṇu, great Brahmā, and immeasurable, uncountable, and incalculable divine sons of the pure abode class and others were also present. The Blessed One together with his retinue was as before.

Then the Blessed One declared: O Vajrapāṇi, lord of secrets, this foundational mantra of secret mantra for the practitioner who accomplishes this sūtra shall be explained extensively and correctly.

Homage to the Three Jewels. Homage to Vajrapāṇi, the great general of yakṣas, the fierce one.

Oṃ kili kili vajra, kili kili ya svāhā. Svāhā to the crown of the head. Svāhā to the forehead. Svāhā to the eyes. Svāhā to the fierce one. Svāhā to the supremely fierce one. Svāhā to the vajra-lasso. Svāhā to the red body. Svāhā to Vajrapāṇi. Svāhā to the lasso-bearer. Svāhā to the sword-bearer. Svāhā to the enemy-foe-bearer. Svāhā to the bow-holder. Svāhā to the stake-holder. Svāhā to the wheel-bearer.

Svāhā to the holder of the trident. Svāhā to the essence. Svāhā to the near essence. Svāhā to the fierce kili kila. Svāhā to the child kili kila. Svāhā to the red kili kila. Svāhā to the greatly powerful one. Svāhā to the matted-haired one. Svāhā to the pendulous-bellied one. Svāhā to the wildly wrathful one. Svāhā to Yama, Lord of Death. Svāhā to the rakṣasa. Svāhā to Yamun the rakṣasa. Svāhā to the greatly fierce one. Svāhā to the cloud. Svāhā to the

mountain-holder. Svāhā to the one who seizes and holds what is cast upon the mountain. Svāhā to the vajra club. Svāhā to the body-terrifier. Svāhā to the threatener. Svāhā to the vajra chain. Svāhā to the vajra stake. Svāhā to the vajra body. Svāhā to the sky-flyer. Svāhā to the nectar. Svāhā to the holder of austerities. Svāhā to the iron hook. Svāhā to the purposeful one. Svāhā to the king of the crown protrusion. Svāhā to the white-colored one. Svāhā to the blue-green color. Svāhā to the slapper. Svāhā to the great elephant. Svāhā to the hands multiplying like eagle's wings. Svāhā to the māra's magical display. Svāhā to the one girdled with a serpent belt. Svāhā to the vajra peg. Svāhā to both hands. Svāhā to ā-vajra. Svāhā to the maker of blazing light. Svāhā to the vajra of steadfast wisdom. Svāhā to the sprout. Svāhā to the light-maker. Svāhā to the vajra-destroyer. Svāhā to the vajra net. Svāhā to vajra-terror. Svāhā to the vajra fist. Svāhā to the cloud-disperser. Svāhā to the rain-reliant one. Svāhā to the vajra iron hook. Svāhā to the vajra essence. Svāhā to the vajra near-essence. Svāhā to the king of thumbs. Svāhā to the king of clubs. Svāhā to the king of armor.

Oṃ dhrī aṃ. Homage to the Three Jewels. Homage to Vajrapāṇi, the fierce great general of yakṣas.

Oṃ hulu hulu. Tiṣṭha tiṣṭha. Bandha bandha. Hana hana. Amṛte hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Oṃ amṛte hūṃ phaṭ svāhā.

Svāhā to Virūḍhaka, guardian of the realm. Svāhā to the ill-eyed one. Svāhā to the noble man. Svāhā to the ill-bodied one. Svāhā to Indra. Svāhā to the fire deity. Svāhā to all the great sages. Svāhā to the sun. Svāhā to the moon. Svāhā to Yama, Lord of Death. Svāhā to Viṣṇu. Svāhā to the lord of rakṣasas. Svāhā to the lord of nāgas. Svāhā to the wind. Svāhā to the lord of power. Svāhā to the consort of the lord of power. Svāhā to Śakra. Svāhā to the son of the wealth deity. Svāhā to the great vajra. Svāhā to the great Brahmā. Svāhā to the earth. Svāhā to the melodious one. Svāhā to the goddess Śrī. Svāhā to the goddess who turns back austerities.

This great vidyā, this king of mighty vidyās, if held in the place of the maṇḍala and kept in mind, shall protect, guard, and shelter. All activities shall be accomplished.

Homage to all the buddhas, the Dharma, the Saṅgha, the pratyekabuddhas, and the entire noble community of śrāvakas. Homage to the elder of great wisdom, Śāradvatīputra. Homage to all the bodhisattvas beginning with Maitreya. Homage to those who have gone forth perfectly. Homage to those

who have entered perfectly. Homage to Vajrapāṇi together with his retinue.

Tadyathā: muni muni mahāmuni, kili kili mahākili, dhike, kaṭa kaṭa mahākaṭa, śama śama śama mahāśama, śātri śātri śātri, śānta śānta śānta, danta danta danta, dhīra dhīra dhīra, mahāmeghaduradhara, hari hari hari, kuṭvi kuṭṭhi kurbi.

chinda chinda chinda, bhinda bhinda bhinda, sarva duṣṭān, gumu gumu gumu, hara hara hara, praṇa nadam nidamni, ṭa ṭa ṭa, ṭhā ṭhā ṭhā, ḍā ḍā ḍā, ḍā ḍā ḍā, ca ca ca, ca ca ca, paca paca paca, daha daha daha, hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ, he he he, phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ, śabari śabari śabari, māṭaṅgi, caṇḍāli, hu hu hu, juhu juhu juhu, hata pratyārin, cili cili cili, phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ, tiṣṭha tiṣṭha tiṣṭha, tiṣṭhatha tiṣṭhatha tiṣṭhatha, mā tikramātha, māṭaṅgi, hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ, he he he.

If you do not remain here, I bind your hands, your feet, your mouth, your throat, your eyes, your heart, and all your speech. Now depart!

jvala jvala jvala, dundhu dundhu dundhu, bandhu bandhu bandhu, nīla nīla nīla, nīlāṅga vajradhara.

Remember the heart-essence called Great Power. koṭi koṭi koṭini, sarva bhūtāni, vajramaṇi, vajradhara, vajraāṭṭahāsa, caratu naratu maratu, kuru kuru kuru, huru huru huru.

Remember the great sentient being. hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ, he he he, phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ, caṇḍa caṇḍa caṇḍa, mahācaṇḍa, hurtu hurtu hurtu, muru muru muru, gṛhṇa gṛhṇa gṛhṇa, Vajrapāṇi, hana hana, mama sarva śatūnām, mūrtini tāḍaya phaṭ, kuru kuru kuru.

Do not act in contradiction to the deeds of Vajrapāṇi. If you transgress the sacred commitment, you will rupture the sacred commitment, and you will deceive even the Tathāgatas. These are the foundations of the secret mantra.

cu cu cu, hara hara hara, phuṭṭu phuṭṭu phuṭṭu, tapani tapani tapani, pacani pacani pacani.

Remember the heart-essence of Vajrapāṇi, which has been blessed by the Tathāgatas.

cili cili cili, phulu phulu phulu, phu phu phu.

O Blessed One, if anyone acts in contradiction to this my heart-essence, may they come to possess the five acts of immediate consequence as declared by the Tathāgatas.

dara phu, cara phu, nara phu.

Homage to Vajrapāṇi together with his retinue. May the foundations of the secret mantra be accomplished for me — svāhā. Homage to Vajrapāṇi of great splendor — svāhā. Oṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ svāhā.

Then at that time, the Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and completely awakened Buddha Śākyamuni blazed with a radiance of rays of light that spread throughout and beyond the great trichiliocosm, and all the abodes of Māra blazed up everywhere, flared up utterly, spread and burned throughout, and appeared on all sides as a single mass of flame.

When this came to pass, the evil Māra, bearing in his hands swords, wheels, bows, arrows, and other weapons, multiplied himself into many apparitions of obstructing spirits. Then, in that very instant, the evil Māra, together with all the sons of the gods of Māra's realm, came to the place where the Blessed One was dwelling, manifesting the great illusory display of Māra.

As this took place, there appeared on every side, in the worlds to the east surpassing in number the grains of sand of twenty-one Ganges rivers, and likewise in the southern, western, and northern directions, a figure blazing with fury, whose complexion was red, whose eyes were crimson-yellow as honey, whose bared fangs were unbearable to behold, whose tangled hair was thrown upward, who held an iron spike in his right hand and a vajra in his left, who was adorned with serpents, and who wore a tiger-skin loincloth.

Then the evil Māra together with billions upon hundreds of thousands of myriads of obstructing spirits trembled with uncontrolled fury. The evil Māra, stupefied and tormented, fell into despair and disregarded his own life, and the Lord of Secrets, Vajrapāṇi, bound him with five noose-bonds.

When that had come to pass, the gods of the Heaven Free from Strife, the Joyful Heaven, the Heaven of Delight in Emanation, and the Heaven of Mastery over Others' Emanations offered incense, flowers, victory banners, pennants of various kinds, and every other such offering they could to the Blessed One, and then took their places to one side.

Then the bodhisattva, the great being, the Lord of Secrets, Vajrapāṇi — praised and celebrated by all the buddhas, who had been made to rejoice — acting out of heartfelt delight in the Blessed One, and for the sake of all sentient beings, for the benefit of gods and humans, and for their welfare and happiness, proclaimed from within the great tantra of the supreme vidyā-mantra these foundations of secret mantra, which are named "Granting

All Desired Aims," which overcomes adversaries with immeasurable power, the great and mighty king of vidyā-mantras:

Whoever holds, carries, reads, extensively and perfectly teaches to others, reveres, takes as their guide, serves with honour, or worships this text will enter into all maṇḍalas. And all secret mantras directed against that person by others will be shattered, broken, and destroyed.

Thus did the Blessed One, the Vajra-Holder, proclaim that which arises from within the great tantra of the supreme vidyā-mantra.

Then the Lord of Secrets, Vajrapāṇi, acting through the Blessed One's heartfelt delight, proclaimed these foundations of secret mantra named "Granting All Desired Aims," which overcomes adversaries with immeasurable power, the mantra of the Mighty One:

Oṃ vajra-krodha mahābala, hana daha paca matha vidhvamsaya, jaṭilaṃ-udara, ucchuṣma-krodha hūṃ phaṭ svāhā.

Then the Lord of Secrets, Vajrapāṇi, addressed the Blessed One with these words: Blessed One, any noble son or noble daughter who hears this Dharma text and holds it, carries it, reads it, extensively and perfectly teaches it to others, honours it, or worships it will receive empowerment into all maṇḍalas.

Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets, then spoke further: As for one who holds the heart-essence of the Mighty One, no yakṣa or son of a yakṣa, no rākṣasa or son of a rākṣasa, no kumbhāṇḍa or son of a kumbhāṇḍa, no garuḍa or son of a garuḍa, no nāga or son of a nāga, no gandharva or son of a gandharva, no flesh-eater or son of a flesh-eater, no madness-causing spirit or son of such a spirit, no ḍākinī or daughter of a ḍākinī, no siddha, no nāga-wielder, nor any such being, nor any possessing spirit that causes forgetfulness, nor corpse-demons, zombies, or the like, nor any possessing spirit of suppression, nor any possessing spirit of forgetfulness or any other such demon will be able to harm that person.

Then the Blessed One spoke to the Lord of Secrets, Vajrapāṇi, saying: Excellent, excellent, Lord of Secrets, Vajrapāṇi! Emptiness. Ultimate emptiness. Emptiness of the ultimate limit. Emptiness of emptiness. Great emptiness. The emptiness of suchness.

Then the Lord of Secrets, Vajrapāṇi, addressed the Blessed One saying: Whoever teaches this sūtra is worthy of being worshipped, venerated, honoured, and circumambulated.

Then the Blessed One, Vajrapāṇi, proclaimed these foundations of secret mantra named "Granting All Desired Aims," which overcomes adversaries with immeasurable power, the mantra of the Mighty One:

Oṃ hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ, phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ — he who holds the trident in his hand, fierce and terrible — hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ, phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ. Oṃ jyotir-nāda, hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ, oṃ oṃ oṃ, phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ. To the Mighty One, svāhā. Oṃ vajra-krodha mahābala, hana daha paca, matha vikira, vidhvāṃsaya, jaṭilaṃ-udara, ucchuṣma-krodha hūṃ phaṭ.

Oṃ jvala jvala, sarva-duṣṭa — stambhaya stambhaya — durācāraṇa-duṣṭa-nivāraya. Protect me, protect me — svāhā. Oṃ ananta-vijaya, mahācaṇḍa — hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Oṃ dhṛka — hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ śrīri, śīro-mālinī, sinisini, śīśini, śīśini. Oṃ sarva-ātmaja, mahāteja-vajra, pāśa-anu, prapīśa, sarva-duṣṭan — stambhaya stambhaya — hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ hūṃ, bandha bandha. Oṃ ananta-vijaya, mahācaṇḍe — hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ, vajra-krodha — hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ vajra-kartarika kara kara, chinda chinda — hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ vajra-krodha, mahābala, dhaka dhaka, jvala jvala — hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ vipura, rakṣa-vajra, vañjara — hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ kili kili, vajra-vajri bhur, bandha bandha — hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ vajri-krodha mahābala, ākarṣaya ākarṣa — hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ vajra-krodha mahābala, dhara dhara, dharaya dhāraya — hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ vajra-krodha mahābala, hana hana, daha daha, dara dara, dāraya dāraya, paṭaya paṭaya, moṭaya moṭaya — hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ vajra-krodha mahābala, taṭa taṭa, taṭaya taṭaya — hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ vajra-krodha mahābala, jvala jvala, prajvala prajvala, dipya dipya, dīpaya dīvaya — hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ curu curu, ucchūṣma-krodha, śikhara hara hara — hūṃ phaṭ.

Homage to the Three Jewels. Homage to Vajrapāṇi, the great yakṣa commander, the fierce and terrible one.

Oṃ vajra-krodha mahācaṇḍa, hana gha-paca, matha vikira, vidhvāṃsaya. Blessed One, come here, come here, come here. Hana hana, hara hara, daha daha, paca paca, vidhvāṃsaya vidhvāṃsaya. Born from the very essence of all offerings made by the lord of gods and asuras, possessed of great splendour — suru suru, muru muru, kuru kuru, ghuru gharu, kurba kurba, mahā-kurba, vikurba, kunaṭṭi, naṭi naṭi, śini śini, khini khini, gakha, khāhi khāhi, kuru kuru, tuṭa tuṭa, tuṭṭa tuṭṭa, traṭṭa traṭṭa, ruru turu. Lord of elemental spirits, lord of nāgas, destroyer of the citadels of the asuras, the great wrathful and ferocious one of immense power — dhama dhama, kara kara, kuru kuru, suru suru — hūṃ phaṭ. Hana hana — hūṃ phaṭ. Daha daha — hūṃ phaṭ. Paca paca — hūṃ

phaṭ. Hrī hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ svāhā. Oṃ culu culu ru — svāhā. Oṃ vajra-krodha mahābala, sarva-duṣṭan, stambhaya stambhaya, mohaya mohaya — hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ ha ha, sara sara, visara visara, ghātaya ghātaya. Oṃ visara, sana trāsaya — hūṃ. Oṃ vajra-krodha mahābala, hara hara, kha kha, khāhi khāhi, nāśaya nāśaya — hūṃ phaṭ. Hūṃ hūṃ, māma, māma phaṭ. Oṃ dhṛka-krodhani, protect me, protect me — svāhā. Oṃ mahābala, vajra-dhara, kara kara, bandha bandha — hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Oṃ jvala-grasa, ucchūṣma-sāgara — hūṃ.

Those sixty-four vajra messengers will also guard, fully protect, shelter, and keep safe.

Vajrapāṇi then declared: Whoever bears this dhāraṇī shall become virtuous. Poison will not harm them. The dying will be revived. Enemies will be unable to prevail. They will have many children. The land around them will become bright and clear. All secret mantras will be accomplished. All activities will become effective. Those seized by malign forces will be sustained and nourished by medicinal water. All poisons will be rendered non-poisonous. Boys and girls who are difficult to deliver in birth will be born safely with ease. If this sūtra is held for three days, it will bring expansion. If it is held for seven days, it will bring great peace.

Then the lord of elemental beings, the sovereign ruler who holds the knowledge-mantras, surrounded by many tens of millions, rose from the maṇḍala of that assembled retinue and, bowing his head at the feet of the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi, the lord of secrets, spoke these words to the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi:

"O you of great power, whose teaching is unobstructed; who overwhelms adversaries with immeasurable strength; Vajrapāṇi, you who are joyful; you who are revered by gods, humans, asuras, Brahmā, and Śakra (Indra); you who strike terror into yakṣas, rākṣasas, revenants, and putrid corpses; you who with your vajra utterly destroy madness-bringers, spirit-expellers, slayers, parching-spirits, powerful ones, mechanical contrivances, those who are entrenched; you who perform all activities; you who bear the secret maṇḍala — may the great bodhisattva please explain."

Then the assembled retinue with all its members acclaimed the lord of elemental beings, the sovereign ruler, saying: "Excellent! Excellent, lord of elemental beings!"

Then the Blessed One, Vajrapāṇi, took up the vajra, and, abiding in the manner of one seated upon a vajra, gazed out over the maṇḍala of the fully assembled retinue and entered into the following meditative absorptions: the absorption called "The Unstoppable Vajra Great Wrathful One Who Utterly Destroys All the Maṇḍalas of Māra"; the absorption called "Great Compassion for All Sentient Beings"; the absorption called "Blazing with Rays of Light and Radiance"; the absorption called "Displaying All the Joy of All Phenomena"; the absorption called "Overwhelming the Domain of All Māras"; the absorption called "The Defining Mark of the Mudrā"; the absorption called "The Object-Domain of All Sentient Beings"; the absorption called "Immovable"; the absorption called "By Means of the Dharma"; the absorption called "The Gateway of the Dharma"; and the absorption called "Great Power."

Then the Blessed One Vajrapāṇi held the vajra aloft in a composed and deliberate manner. Then, abiding in the manner of one resting upon a lotus, he gazed out over the maṇḍala of the fully assembled retinue, and entered into meditative equipoise in the absorption called "Bringing Joy" — he being the wrathful, disheveled one, adorned with a belt of snakes.

The moment he had entered that equipoise, he himself perceived that the disheveled wrathful one was making many hundreds of thousands of tens of millions of obstructing spirits tremble and be crushed. Those spirits, scorched, moaned and gave up their lives; thinking it to be the kalpa of conflagration, they wept in voices of desperation. They went before the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi and cried out: "Blessed One, please fully protect us! Bodhisattva, please fully protect us! Blessed One, we are being crushed and intoxicated by the Blessed One's disheveled wrathful one, and in our wretchedness we no longer care for our very lives!"

Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi arose from that absorption and spoke to all the maṇḍalas of Māra: "How wondrous! This great wrathful one has tremendous miraculous power! He has tremendous might!"

And they, in turn, said: "Blessed One, it is so — how wondrous! This great wrathful one has tremendous miraculous power! He has tremendous might!"

Then the Blessed One, the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi, fixed his lion's gaze upon the lord of elemental beings and, together with the secret maṇḍala of the disheveled wrathful one, declared:

Oṃ vajra krodha mahābala, hana hana paca matha vidhāna saya, jaṭilaṃ bodara, ucchuṣṣma krodha hūṃ phaṭ, a ā ma mā mahā svāhā.

"Friends, whoever enters the maṇḍala of this great wrathful one of tremendous power — all their aims shall be accomplished. They shall not be made to die at an untimely hour. No fierce karma or illness of any kind shall be able to harm their body. Obstacles, malevolent humans, and misdirecting spirits shall find no opening to exploit them. All people shall rejoice in them. All enemies shall be destroyed. For one who enters here, all secret mantras shall be accomplished, and the rites of every wrathful one shall be fulfilled spontaneously and effortlessly. For one who receives empowerment here, liberation from every inauspicious omen shall be won, and they shall be blessed with glory."

Then the great wrathful one performed the customary preliminary actions and declared: whoever creates the maṇḍala of the great wrathful one, or repairs what has been made, or knows the tantra, or possesses the eight limbs of the restoration ceremony, or has gone for refuge to the Three Jewels, or is endowed with the awakening mind, or is possessed of a mind of loving-kindness, or has become compassionate, or has beheld the maṇḍala, or has received empowerment, or has been granted the scriptural transmission by the masters — whoever bears and recites this, which is called the Great King of Vidyā Mantras (Skt. vidyārāja), the one of tremendous power, that destroys all māras and every hostile mind — no māra and no enemy shall be able to harm them. They shall be freed from all fears arising from yakṣas, rākṣasas, hungry ghosts, flesh-eating demons, putrid corpse-spirits, ḍākinīs, amnesia-causing spirits, sorcery spirits, snake-seizers, and all others of that kind. They shall be freed from every kind of fear. They shall be freed from all untimely death. They shall be freed from all killing and imprisonment. They shall be freed from all wounding. They shall be freed from all terrors of stupefying spirits, maddening spirits, and bewildering spirits. They shall be freed from all terrors of nāgas. They shall be freed from every inauspiciousness.

Whatever impoverished sentient being bears, recites, calls to mind, or remembers this teaching under this name at any of the three times — morning, midday, or evening — shall be freed from every suffering of poverty.

In a year of poor harvests, if the one of tremendous power is recited seven times, rain shall fall from great clouds. If rain does not fall, the lives of the cloud deities shall wither and dry up. The nāga kings Kṛṣṇa, Cakra, Ananta, and the other nāga kings shall cause rain to fall from great clouds; and if they

do not cause it to fall, their lives too shall wither and dry up.

In accordance with the rite described above, whether at a cardinal point, on a riverbank, beside the ocean, beside a lake, or at a stūpa site, one should make a great offering to the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi — with red sandalwood, oleander blossoms, red lotuses, atimuktaka flowers, campaka flowers, victory banners, red pennants and the like, and vases filled with fragrant water, and so forth — and make a great offering in this way. Whoever bears and recites this sūtra shall, even upon entering every battlefield, be unassailable by the enemy. All sentient beings shall rejoice in them. They shall be liberated from every inauspiciousness.

If the one of tremendous power is attached to the tip of a victory banner and one goes into battle, the enemy shall not be able to prevail. If the secret mantra is written on birch bark and bound upon the crown of the head, then in battle all weapons shall fall like flowers.

Then that māra circumambulated the Blessed One three times, and sitting to one side, asked: "What is meant by 'the one of tremendous power'?" The Blessed One declared: "'The one of tremendous power' refers to the Tathāgata. 'The one of tremendous power' refers to the Dharma. 'The one of tremendous power' refers to the aggregate of Dharma. 'The one of tremendous power' refers to the way of Dharma. 'The one of tremendous power' refers to the Great Vehicle. 'The one of tremendous power' refers to Vajrapāṇi."

Then the wicked māra said: "Excellent, excellent, O Vajrapāṇi, Lord of Secrets! I take refuge. I take refuge in the Buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha. Excellent, excellent, O Blessed One! I shall take up the precepts of a layman. For the sake of happiness, liberation, and the higher realms, and for the benefit of the learned and all holy sentient beings, I shall uphold the one of tremendous power."

Then the wicked māra, seeing with joy, mental ease, and delight in the Dharma, the Blessed One declared: "This sūtra, the King of Vidyā-mantras called 'The One of Tremendous Power,' liberates sentient beings from the suffering of hell-beings, animals, hungry ghosts, and the world of the Lord of Death. Through it one shall become a king of gods for twenty thousand aeons. For countless aeons one shall become a wheel-turning sovereign (cakravartin) holding dominion over the four continents. And it establishes one upon the path of unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

"This essence of the King of Vidyā-mantras called 'The One of Tremendous Power' accomplishes its purpose whether one is pure or impure, whether one has fasted or not, or even for one who follows the way of sexual conduct. For such a person there shall be no obstacles."

Then Subhūti, who was present in that very assembly, asked the Blessed One: "How should one uphold this King of Vidyā-mantras, 'The One of Tremendous Power'? What does the holy one prescribe?" The Blessed One declared: "Ask Vajrapāṇi."

Subhūti said: "Vajrapāṇi, how should one uphold this King of Vidyā-mantras, 'The One of Tremendous Power'? What does the holy one give?" Vajrapāṇi said: "One gives grain. One gives clothing. One gives silver. One gives gold. One gives cattle. One gives whatever holy thing is desired."

Subhūti said: "What is called the general fruit?" Vajrapāṇi said: "Subhūti, it is just so. For sentient beings obscured by afflictions, it abides at the time of fruition. It abides for the sake of the qualities of the time of fruition. Through the purpose of those qualities it establishes one upon the path of unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening."

Subhūti then spoke in verse:

Excellent, excellent, O Vajrapāṇi,
endowed with the defining mark of the secret!
The one of tremendous power is possessed of wisdom,
replete with the excellent mark of the secret.
Empowerment poured from above, the mind made firm,
truly endowed with the signs.
Great in generosity, moral discipline, and wisdom,
great in miraculous power, great in strength,
renowned for great sovereignty, great in merit —
the one of tremendous power, the pinnacle of qualities.
For the purpose of conferring empowerment upon this sūtra,
eight thousand buddhas came there.

The bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi, by means of this very sūtra, placed the fearless hand upon the crown of the head, and virtuous deeds shall be performed. Whoever keeps this dhāraṇī-mantra in the earth, on a mountain, on a riverbank, or at the seashore shall become free from fear of every terror.

Then the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi addressed the Blessed One as follows:

Whoever keeps, recites, and extensively and correctly teaches this sūtra to others shall live for a hundred years free from illness.

Vajrapāṇi then asked again: "What is the name of this enumeration of Dharma teachings, and how shall we hold it?"

The Blessed One declared: "Hold this sūtra by the name 'Emanation of the Tathāgata.' Hold it also by the name 'Sun of the Dharma.' Hold it also by the name 'Accomplisher of All Aims.' Hold it also by the name 'Dharma-Cloud of All the Tathāgatas.' Hold it also by the name 'Dhāraṇī-Mantra That Purifies All Misdeeds.' Hold it also by the name 'King of Accomplishment of All Who Hold Vidyā-Mantras.' Hold it also by the name 'Perfection of Wisdom.' Hold it also by the name 'Dharmadhātu, Forerunner of All the Tathāgatas.' Hold it also by the name 'Great Powerful King of Vidyā-Mantras.'

"O Lord of Secrets, Vajrapāṇi, whoever holds, keeps, reads, transcribes, pays homage to, reveres, illustrates, and makes offerings to this sūtra shall have thereby made offerings to the buddhas and bodhisattvas of the past, future, and present. They shall also have made offerings to the reliquary shrines together with the relics of all those of the past, future, and present.

Vajrapāṇi replied: "Excellent, Blessed One! Excellent! We shall hold the teaching of the profoundly deep Dharma and the teaching of the Dharma adorned with the qualities of miraculous power."

The Blessed One then declared: "Vajrapāṇi, whatever son or daughter of good family keeps this sūtra — the sentient beings who are hostile toward them shall become as unfit as a tree on a riverbank. If offerings are made with incense, flowers, fragrant substances, victory banners, various pennants, and the like, one will come to possess an immeasurable accumulation of merit. No obstacles shall arise for such a person. Wherever this sūtra is kept in any place, gods together with humans shall make offerings there.

"The Great Powerful King of Vidyā-Mantras — when one bears in mind that it binds all obstructors and all misleading spirits, eight thousand buddhas, great bodhisattvas, great sages, gods, nāgas, and gandharvas together rejoice. At the time of rejoicing in this dhāraṇī-mantra of the Great Powerful One, the Tathāgata Śākyamuni spoke thus:

"O Lord of Secrets, Vajrapāṇi, those who do not show reverence toward this sūtra shall be born in the eight great hells. O Lord of Secrets, Vajrapāṇi, those who do show reverence toward this sūtra, who honor it and make offerings to

it, shall come to possess an immeasurable accumulation of merit. Whoever transcribes it or listens to a single recitation of it shall attain the path to awakening from which there is no turning back."

Vajrapāṇi said: "Among sentient beings, whoever thinks wrongly about the Sage's Dharma — which is inconceivable, supremely subtle, supremely profound, and beyond reckoning — shall be confounded."

The Blessed One declared: "O Lord of Secrets, Vajrapāṇi, this sūtra is to be expounded for the benefit of sentient beings: to remove the obscurations of all sentient beings, to pacify, to increase, to confer empowerment, to liberate from all inauspiciousness, to consecrate with splendor and blessings, and to purify all misdeeds —"

— and so that all sentient beings may attain unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening."

Thereupon, the eight thousand Tathāgatas formed a circle, and, paying homage three times to the Tathāgata Śākyamuni, they joined their palms together and rejoiced, exclaiming: "Excellent! Excellently has this been expounded!"

Then the Tathāgata Śākyamuni replied to those buddhas: "Blessed Ones, excellent, excellent! Excellently has it been expounded!"

The Blessed One then declared: "By the power of this teaching of the secret Dharma of great potency, Vajrapāṇi the bodhisattva has seen the hearts of all hostile obstructers and all misleading spirits tremble and shake. Homage to the Three Jewels! Homage to Vajrapāṇi, the great lord of yakṣa hosts, the fierce one!

Tadyathā: Oṃ hana hana vajra, daha daha vajra, paca paca vajra, matha matha vajra, jvala jvala, suru suru, muru muru, kaṭaṃ kaṭe, jaye, vijaye, aparājite, māresenāpramardanāya svāhā."

The Blessed One then declared: "O Lord of Secrets, Vajrapāṇi — scatter all obstructers and misleading spirits! Bind them! Utterly vanquish them! Make what has not been accomplished, accomplished! Make what has been accomplished, tame! Cause all buddhas and bodhisattvas to descend! Let all gods and nāgas come here, come here! Through my fierce power of great potency, may all be made wholesome!"

Then the youthful Mañjuśrī rose from his seat, draped his upper robe over one shoulder, placed his right knee on the ground, joined his palms toward the

Blessed One, bowed his head, and addressed the Blessed One in these words: "Blessed One, what is the nature of the characteristic of impermanence in all formations?"

The Blessed One declared: "O bodhisattva, youthful Mañjuśrī, listen well! All formations are like a city of gandharvas. All formations are like lightning and clouds. All formations are like a house afire and smoke. All formations are like a lamp flame. All formations are like a water bubble. All formations are like a plantain tree. All formations are like an image in a painting. All formations are like a flower. All formations are like a dream. These formations are like the wheel of pleasure and pain. These formations are like a river of pleasure and pain. Since they are agitated and turbulent, they are like an ocean. They are like stars. Sentient beings do not think of these formations as arising, do not see them, do not know them, do not encounter them — yet the Tathāgata himself sees them. The Tathāgata himself encounters them. The Tathāgata himself knows them. All formations he knows as having a single characteristic: emptiness. He knows them as having the characteristic of ultimate emptiness. He knows them as having the characteristic of emptiness that transcends extremes. He knows them as having the characteristic of emptiness that is itself empty. He knows them as having the characteristic of great emptiness. He knows them as having the characteristic of suchness as emptiness.

"O youthful Mañjuśrī, having seen these characteristics and having understood this very characteristic, bodhisattvas who are engaged in practice engage in the perfection of generosity. And likewise they engage in the perfections of moral discipline, patience, diligence, meditative concentration, and wisdom."

To know this very characteristic is what it means to be a bodhisattva.

Then the bodhisattva, the great being, the noble Avalokiteśvara circumambulated the Blessed One three times, sat down to one side, and spoke these words: "Blessed One, by what characteristic is this sūtra to be called an emanation of the Tathāgata?"

The Blessed One declared: "Noble Avalokiteśvara, when the Tathāgata has passed fully into nirvāṇa, this sūtra will perform the deeds of the Tathāgata — by that characteristic it is called an emanation of the Tathāgata. When this sūtra has completely disappeared, the teaching of the Tathāgata will have completely disappeared — by that characteristic it is called an emanation of the Tathāgata. While this sūtra lives and abides, the teaching of the Tathāgata also lives and abides — by that characteristic it is called an emanation of the

Tathāgata. All the Tathāgatas themselves pay homage to this very sūtra — by that characteristic it is called an emanation of the Tathāgata."

Then the noble Avalokiteśvara rejoiced in the Blessed One's words, declared that he would act in accordance with the teaching, and asked: "Who shall bear this sūtra?"

The Blessed One declared: "By the power of this very sūtra, all the buddhas and bodhisattvas will come, and all the gods will come as well." And all the gods spoke thus: "Excellent! Excellent! We too rejoice at being given this holy teaching. All the buddhas and bodhisattvas will also bestow this very holy teaching."

The Blessed One then declared: "Vajrapāṇi, lord of secrets, the secret essence of the great mighty one bestows every happiness upon all sentient beings."

Then the bodhisattva, the great being Vajrapāṇi, spoke to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, by what characteristic is this sūtra called 'preceded by the dharmadhātu'?"

The Blessed One declared: "Son of good family, after every Tathāgata arises and thirty-two days have passed, they teach the Dharma of this very sūtra on a great mountain. By that characteristic it is called 'preceded by the dharmadhātu.' By the power of this very sūtra, all the buddhas and bodhisattvas abide in the first arousal of the awakening mind — by that characteristic it is called 'preceded by the dharmadhātu.' By the power of this very sūtra, countless and immeasurable sons of the gods entered the stream. Son of good family, all the Tathāgatas arouse the perception of this sūtra's bearer and reader as their own son, and at the moment of death they place them on the path to nirvāṇa."

Vajrapāṇi then offered these verses:

The buddhas wander through saṃsāra for pure-minded beings,
drawing out the stake of existence with wisdom;
crushing the stake of existence and the river of mind,
by teaching the Dharma of the Capable One, evil is vanquished — practice the Dharma well.

The Blessed One declared: "Excellent! Excellent! Vajrapāṇi has spoken well."

Vajrapāṇi asked: "What accumulation of merit will be obtained by whoever bears this sūtra, reads it, and extensively and correctly teaches it to others?"

The Blessed One declared: "Son of good family, whoever bears this sūtra, reads it, and extensively and correctly teaches it to others will attain ten million meditative absorptions and will behold ten million buddhas and bodhisattvas together with their retinues."

They will behold many hundreds of thousands of tens of millions of Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and completely awakened buddhas, and with great-hearted intention they will pay homage to them, take them as their teachers, attend upon them with reverence, and make offerings to them. They will offer robes, alms-food, bedding, medicine for the sick, and all manner of requisites. They will accomplish the welfare and happiness of bodhisattvas and will attend with reverence upon the assembly of the Saṅgha. All those roots of virtue they will fully dedicate to unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening. They will serve and honor those Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and completely awakened buddhas; and with reverence they will listen to, hold, and read the Dharma those buddhas teach. They will overcome the power of the enemy just as the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi does. By the might of this wrathful one who is of great power and overcomes the enemy: svasti svasti, siddhi siddhi svāhā.

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, the noble Maitreya, Mañjuśrī, the noble Avalokiteśvara, and all the bodhisattvas of the Fortunate Aeon; the great bodhisattvas such as Vajragarbha and the rest; all those assembled from the world-systems of the ten directions; gods, nāgas, yakṣas, rākṣasas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, great serpents, and all humans and non-humans — the entire retinue gathered there, and Vajrapāṇi as well, rejoiced at what the Blessed One had said and praised it with delight.

This completes the Great Vehicle sūtra called "The Noble One of Great Power."

Translated by the Indian master Śīlendrabodhi and Jinamitra, along with the Tibetan editor —

Translator's Notes

- The opening line renders a colophon for a preceding text, the praise with mantra to "Sme brtsegs" — a wrathful deity whose name I have transliterated as Smoky Flame following common convention; the exact Sanskrit equivalent is uncertain and the name may be unique to this Tibetan context.

The term rendered "great Ḡḍhrakūṭa mountain" is literally "the great mountain of the abandoned stone" in Tibetan, which corresponds in the tradition to Ḡḍhrakūṭa (Vulture Peak) near Rājagṛha, though the Tibetan spelling here is non-standard.

"Virūḍhaka" renders "yul 'khor srung," the guardian king of the south, one of the four great kings; "Śakra" renders "dbang bo," the lord of gods. "Kubera" renders "lus ngan po," the lord of the north, which conventionally designates Vaiśravaṇa/Kubera in these assembly lists.

"Amṛtakundalī" and "Śuddhaviṣa" are rendered from their Sanskrit forms reconstructed from the Tibetan; these are well-attested tantric deity names.

The mantra syllables are reproduced as they appear; "kili kili" is a characteristic seed-syllable sequence associated with Vajrapāṇi and is not translated.

- The term rendered "Virūḍhaka, guardian of the realm" translates རྒྱལ་ཁོང་སྐྱོང་པ་, which is the standard Tibetan rendering of Virūḍhaka, one of the Four Great Kings; the identification is secure from the epithet's standard usage.

The phrase རྒྱལ་ཁོང་སྐྱོང་པ་ ("to both hands") is brief and formulaic in this liturgical context; it likely refers to Vajrapāṇi's two hands, though some ritual traditions specify separate hand implements.

The term རྒྱལ་ཁོང་སྐྱོང་པ་ is the Tibetan phonetic rendering of Śāradvatīputra, a name for Śāriputra; this is the elder of great wisdom par excellence in the tradition, and the identification is certain.

- The phrase rendered "remember" for "dran par gyis shig" in the mantra context carries a sense of "invoke" or "bear in mind" — the Tibetan imperative here is addressed to the spirit being commanded, calling its attention to the named essence or being as a source of authority. This is standard in dhāraṇī literature and does not require further gloss.

The five acts of immediate consequence (Sanskrit: pañcānantarya) are the five heinous deeds — matricide, patricide, killing an arhat, wounding a buddha, and causing schism in the Saṅgha — which bring immediate karmic retribution without interval. The curse-formula here threatens that a violator of the mantra will accrue these as their spiritual consequence.

- The passage lists a series of spirit-categories that harm humans. The term rendered "flesh-eater" represents a class of malevolent beings distinct from rākṣasas; the Tibetan indicates a meat-eating demon. "Son of a ḍākinī" follows the grammatical pattern of the other pairs, though the feminine form is used throughout for ḍākinīs. The mantras are transliterated as they appear in the Tibetan phonetic rendering; minor orthographic variation between the first and second occurrence of the mantra is reproduced faithfully, as it is present in the source.

- The passage "born from the very essence of all offerings made by the lord of gods and asuras" renders a phrase describing Vajrapāṇi as having arisen from the totality of worship offered by the sovereign lords of both gods and asuras — this is a standard cosmological enthronement formula in wrathful dhāraṇī literature and is rendered accordingly.

The phrase translated "boys and girls who are difficult to deliver in birth will be born safely with ease" more literally describes children dwelling in the womb who will then be delivered comfortably — the rendering preserves the obstetric sense.

- The epithets of Vajrapāṇi enumerated by the lord of elemental beings form a string of honorific salutations that blend his tantric functions: his unobstructed teaching, his immeasurable power, his subjugation of both celestial and demonic beings. The list of beings he terrifies — yakṣas, rākṣasas, revenants, and putrid bodies — and the forces he destroys — including "mechanical contrivances" (ལྷ་མཁོ་ལྷ་མཁོ་, yantra-type devices used in harmful ritual) — reflects the standard enumeration of malefic forces in the tantra's protective context.

The phrase rendered "disheveled wrathful one" translates རྒྱལ་ཁོང་སྐྱོང་པ་, literally "the loose or disheveled wrathful one," a specific iconographic and ritual designation for a wild-haired, unbound wrathful deity form.

The mantra at the close is reproduced phonetically as it appears in the Tibetan; no regularized Sanskrit reconstruction is offered, as the syllabic spellings follow tantric convention.

- The term rendered "putrid corpse-spirits" translates a compound meaning bodies in a state of decay or reanimated corpses, a category of malevolent being in the Indian demonological tradition.

The phrase "at any of the three times" refers to the traditional threefold division of the day in Indian Buddhist practice: morning, midday, and evening.

The nāga kings named here — Kṛṣṇa ("the Black"), Cakra ("the Wheel"), and Ananta ("the Endless") — are standard figures in Indian nāga lore associated with rain-bringing.

- The phrase rendered "the way of Dharma" translates ธรรมะวิถี, which could also mean "the mode or manner of Dharma." The present rendering is a reasonable middle ground but the exact referent is context-dependent.

The passage promising accomplishment even for "one who follows the way of sexual conduct" is doctrinally notable: it is a standard tantric formula asserting that the power of the vidyā-mantra is not conditional on celibacy or ritual purity, applying equally to householders and monastics.

"The fearless hand" placed upon the crown is a standard gesture of protection and authorization (*abhaya-mudrā* combined with crown-touching), well attested in tantric ritual contexts.

- The term rendered "illustrates" for 寫像 (shōzō) literally means "to make into a picture or painting," referring to the practice of creating illustrated manuscript copies; this is a standard devotional act listed alongside transcription and recitation.

The phrase "tree on a riverbank" is a traditional simile for something exposed, unstable, and liable to fall — hostile beings will be rendered harmless and ineffectual.

- The mantra passage is rendered phonetically as it stands in the Tibetan transliteration; the Sanskrit underlying several forms is recoverable but the text functions liturgically, so no emendation has been made.

The phrase rendered "a house afire and smoke" translates a compound meaning literally "a house and smoke," which in classical Buddhist simile literature refers to a burning house filling with smoke — an image of impermanence and imminent collapse. The translation conveys the intended sense without over-explaining.

The "city of gandharvas" is a classical Indian simile for a mirage-city that appears real but has no substantial existence, standard in Prajñāpāramitā literature; no gloss was inserted into the body since the image reads naturally in context.

- The verse attributed to Vajrapāṇi is compact and imagistic. The phrase rendered "stake of existence" translates *srid pa'i phur bu*, a striking metaphor for the peg or thorn of conditioned existence that pins beings in *saṃsāra*; "river of mind" renders *sems klung*, the torrent of mind. The verse's final line, *sdig 'joms chos legs spyod*, is terse: "vanquishing evil, practice the Dharma well." The rendering preserves the exhortatory tone.

The passage "thirty-two days have passed" (zhag sum cu rtsa gnyis lon pa'i nyin mo) is an unusual and specific detail; it most likely refers to the traditional account that the Buddha spent thirty-two days after awakening before beginning to teach.

- The mantra passage "svasti svasti, siddhi siddhi svāhā" is rendered in transliteration as it appears, being a dhāraṇī formula not subject to semantic translation. The colophon breaks off mid-sentence at the name of the Tibetan editor, reflecting an incomplete transmission of the colophon in the source text.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.